SEO CASE STUDY | 3-MONTH MILESTONE

# How We Grew Google Visibility for a Phoenix-Area Trenchless Sewer Company by 47% in 3 Months

Client: Pipeliners (pipelinersusa.com)

Market: Phoenix metro, Arizona

Period: June 2026 baseline to September 2026

47% = growth in Google search terms the site ranks for (345 to 507, Search Atlas, US).

Prepared by TAG Marketing | September 2026

# 1. Executive Summary

Pipeliners is a trenchless sewer, drain and water line repair company serving the Phoenix metro area, with dedicated service pages for 37 Valley communities from Mesa and Gilbert to Buckeye and Florence. Between June and September 2026, the number of Google searches the website ranks for grew **47%** (345 to 507), Google impressions rose **4%**, and organic visitors became **14% more engaged**, while clicks from Google held steady. The site now ranks **#1** in Phoenix for "florence pipe break repair" and is earning organic visits on city and blog pages that had none in June.

| +47% | +4.1% | +13.9% | #1 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ranking keywords<br>345 to 507 (Search Atlas) | Google impressions<br>same 21 days (GSC) | Organic engagement rate<br>48.5% to 55.2% (GA4) | florence pipe break repair<br>Phoenix (Rank Tracker) |

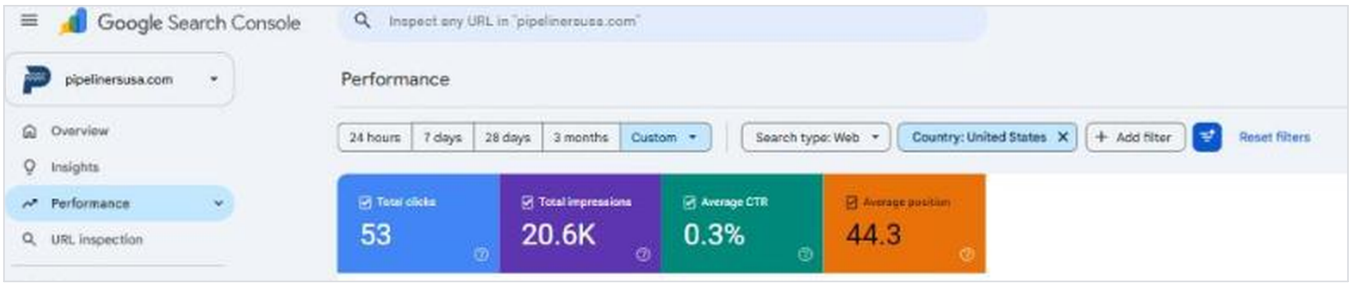
**How to read the numbers**
Google Search Console (GSC) and Google Analytics 4 (GA4) are Google's own data. Search Atlas figures are third-party estimates. June and September are compared on the same 21 days (1 to 21) because September was not finished when this was prepared.

# 2. The Local Challenge

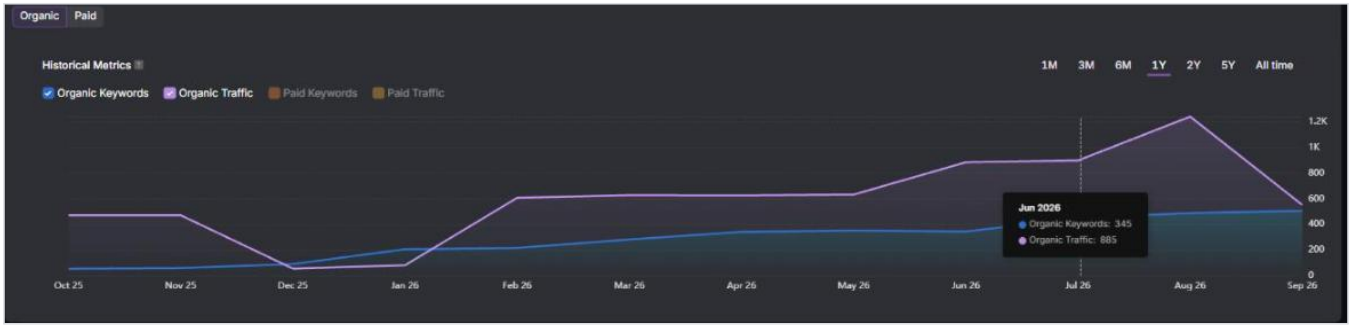
Pipeliners was paying for almost all of its website traffic and leads. In June 2026, organic search was a small, under-performing channel:

- **Organic search was only about 7% of website visits.** Most visits came from paid ads (Cross-network, Display, Paid Search) and direct traffic.
- **No leads came from organic search.** All 11 of June's website leads came from other channels, so every new job depended on ad spend.
- **Visibility was deep in the results.** The site averaged position 44 in Google (page 4 to 5) and got 53 clicks in the whole month. The biggest single sources of clicks were people already searching the company name.
- **The site had technical and content debt.** Hidden keyword blocks injected by an SEO plugin, city-page copy hidden on mobile, unstyled headings, thin city pages, and a Site Health score of 909 out of 1,000 (June 16 crawl).

## Baseline evidence (June 2026)




*Google Search Console, June 1 to 30, 2026 (Web, United States): 53 clicks, 20.6K impressions, 0.3% CTR, average position 44.3.*




*Search Atlas Site Explorer (US), June 2026: 345 organic keywords, 885 estimated organic visits.*




*Search Atlas Site Audit history: Site Health 909 on the June 16, 2026 crawl.*

# 3. The Specialized Strategy & Execution

The work focused on the 37 city pages and the technical layer, using Search Atlas (OTTO, Site Audit, Keyword Rank Tracker), Google Search Console data and direct WordPress/Elementor edits. Dates are when each change went live.

### Technical overhaul

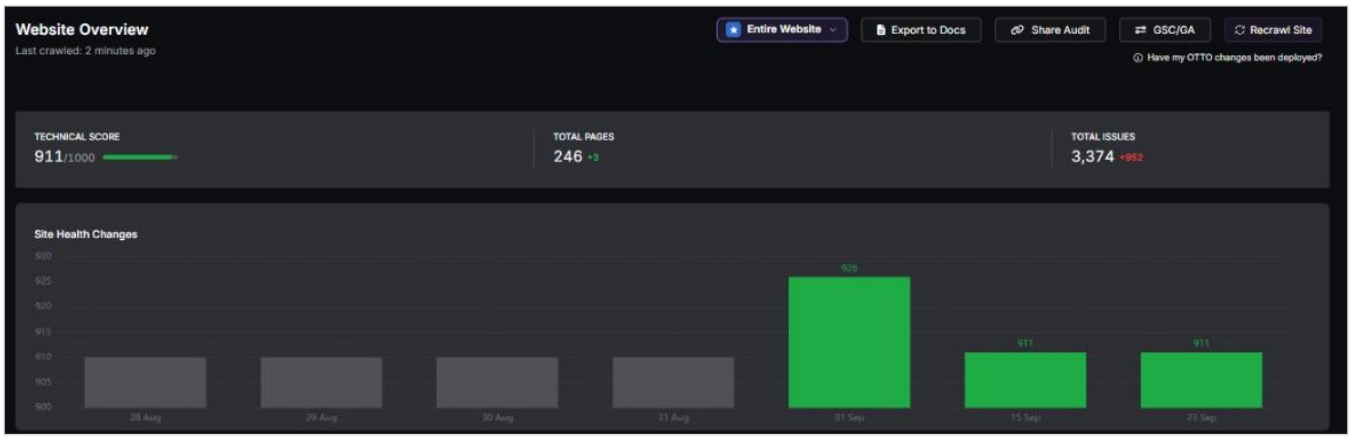
- **Removed hidden keyword blocks** that the OTTO plugin had injected site-wide (hidden headings, keyword lists and FAQs). Hidden words on the site dropped from **20,648 to 481** (Sep 12).
- **Made city-page copy visible on mobile** on all 37 city pages. About 250 words per page had been hidden on phones (Aug 28).
- **Moved plugin-injected FAQs into real on-page FAQ sections** with valid FAQPage schema: 4 pages, 48 questions (Aug 27).
- **Fixed 36 unstyled headings** across 21 city pages so every section uses the proper heading structure (Sep 2).
- **Cleaned up Search Console**: removed dead sitemaps so Google only reads the live sitemap (Sep 15).
- Result on the latest audit: **server errors (5xx) down from 8 to 0**.

### On-page and content

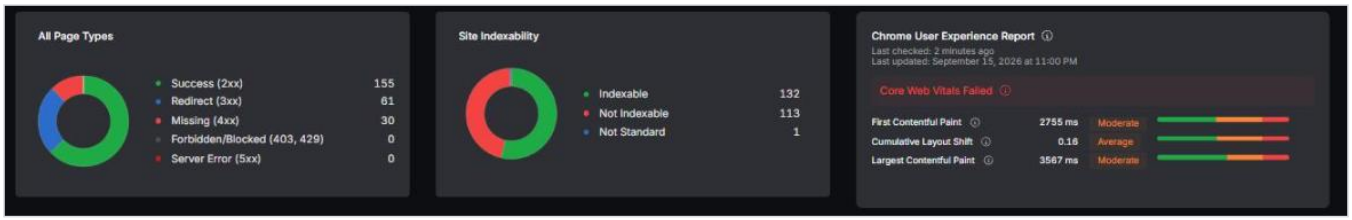
- **Audited all 37 city page titles and descriptions** against live pages: 37 of 37 clean (Aug 31).
- **Rewrote titles and descriptions for Tempe, Buckeye and Florence** using each page's real Search Console keywords (Aug 31).
- **Added service content to thin city pages**, chosen by local search demand rather than word count (from Sep 1).
- **Aligned one focus keyword per page** across title, H1, description and a new answer-first section on Tempe, Mesa, Gilbert and Fountain Hills, then Florence, Phoenix, Chandler, Queen Creek and Hydro Jetting (Sep 16 to 17).
- **Strengthened internal linking**: replaced generic "here!" link text with descriptive links and added links to the priority city pages.

> **Timing**
> Most of this work went live between late August and mid-September. The September comparison window (Sep 1 to 21) only captures the first weeks after these changes, and the Sep 16 to 17 updates are too recent to show in it yet.

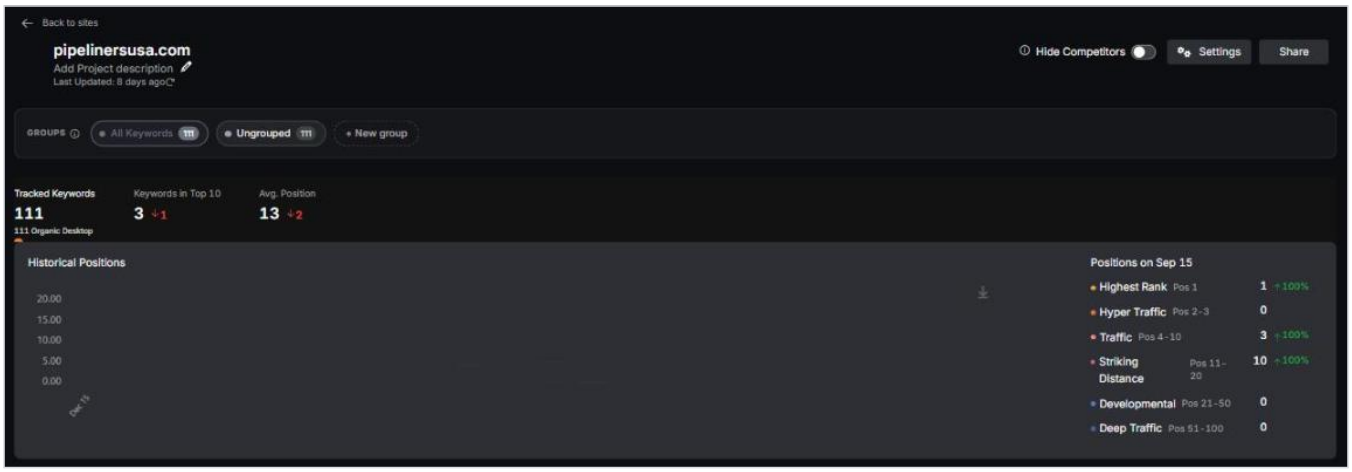
## Execution evidence




*Search Atlas Site Audit after a fresh crawl (Sep 23, 2026): Technical Score 911/1000.*




*Current status codes and indexability: 0 server errors (5xx).*




*Search Atlas Keyword Rank Tracker (Phoenix and US, 111 keywords): positions on Sep 15, 2026.*

# 4. The Results

Same filters and the same 21 days in each month (June 1 to 21 vs September 1 to 21), unless marked otherwise.

| Metric | June | September | Change | Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ranking keywords (US) | 345 | 507 | **+47%** | Search Atlas (monthly) |
| Google impressions | 13,983 | 14,555 | **+4.1%** | GSC |
| Google clicks | 31 | 32 | +3.2% | GSC |
| Organic visits | 99 | 96 | -3.0% | GA4 |
| Organic engaged sessions | 48 | 53 | **+10.4%** | GA4 |
| Organic engagement rate | 48.5% | 55.2% | **+13.9%** | GA4 |
| Organic time on site | 52s | 1m 01s | **+15.9%** | GA4 |
| Site Health score | 909 (Jun 16) | 911 (Sep 23) | +2 | Site Audit |
| Organic leads (key events) | 0 | 0 | No change yet | GA4 |

### Wins so far

- **More of Arizona can find Pipeliners:** the site ranks for 162 more search terms than in June.
- **#1 in Phoenix for "florence pipe break repair"** and #4 nationally, after the Florence page work.
- **New pages are earning organic visits:** /gilbert (rebuilt and keyword-aligned in September) and four blog posts received organic visits for the first time.
- **Better-quality visitors:** organic is now the most engaged channel on the site, at about a minute per visit versus 8 seconds for direct traffic.

### Organic leads (phone calls and forms)

GA4 records leads as the **generate_lead** event, and that tracking is working: leads kept recording through September. **None of them came from organic search in either period**, so the case study does not claim a lead increase yet. Growing organic leads is the goal for the next milestone. The next measurements are the full-month September pull (Oct 3) and the city-page reviews on Oct 9 and Oct 22.

## Performance comparison: Google Search Console

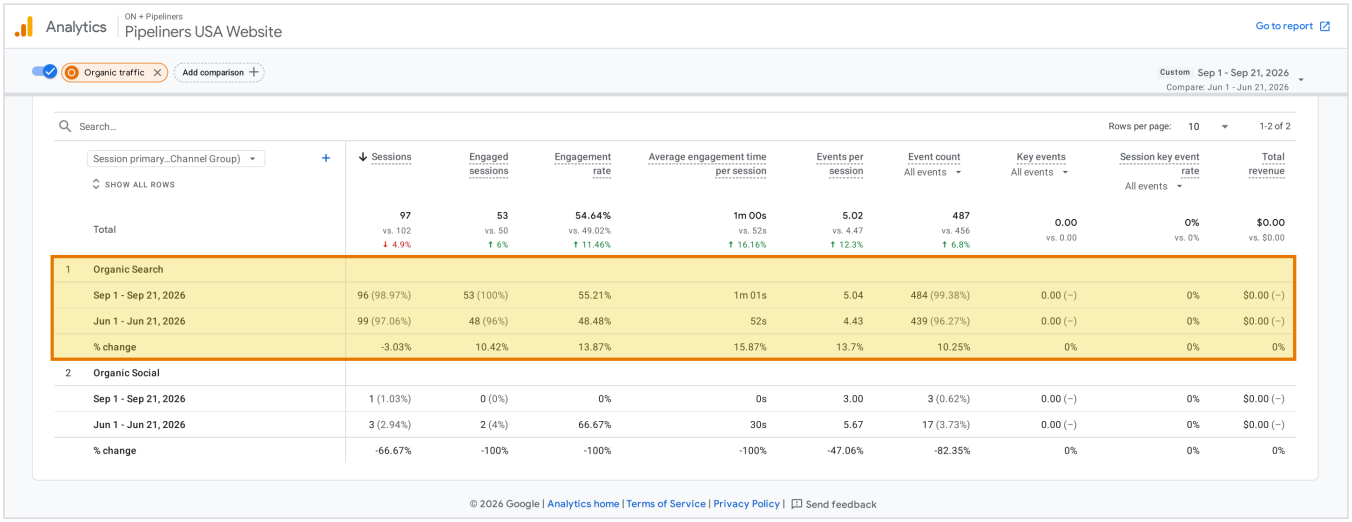



*GSC, June 1 to 21, 2026: 31 clicks, 14K impressions, position 43.1.*

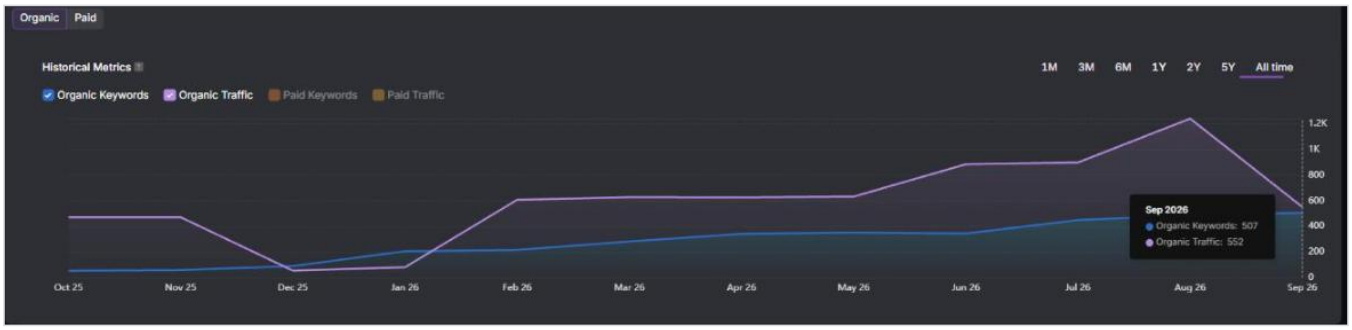



*GSC, September 1 to 21, 2026: 32 clicks, 14.6K impressions, position 46.1.*

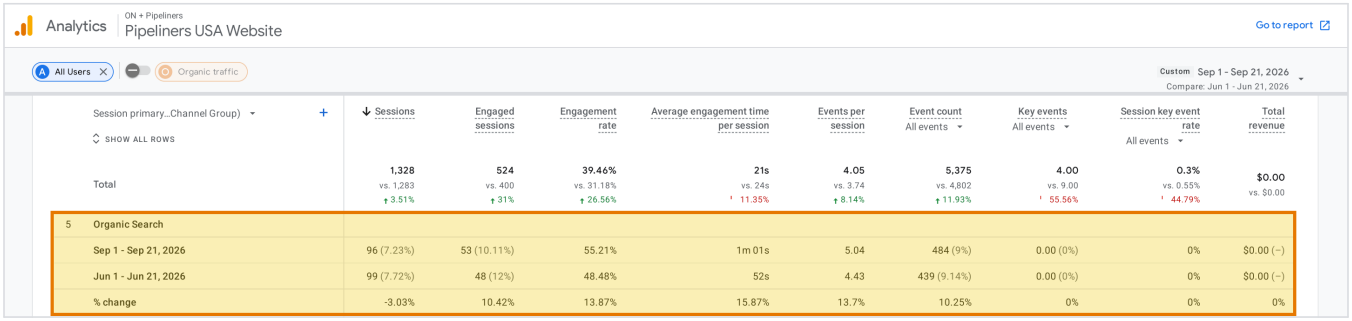
## Performance comparison: Google Analytics 4 (Organic Search highlighted)




*GA4 Traffic acquisition, organic traffic, September 1 to 21 vs June 1 to 21, 2026.*




*Search Atlas Site Explorer (US), September 2026: 507 organic keywords (June: 345).*




*GA4, all channels: Organic Search highlighted within total site traffic.*

Changes in these numbers show what happened during the period; SEO work is one of several factors that can affect them.